Aero Peru 603

Flight model: Boeing 757
Date: October, 1996

From: Peru
To: Chile

The Boeing 757, at that period was one of the most advanced aircraft that had computer controlling the aircraft and had monitors in the cockpit to view the gauges and to assist the pilots.

Problem

At the Dark. The flight took off normal. Within minutes after takeoff the pilots received an unusual warning. The altimeter in the display module got stuck. The Boeing 757 had 3 altimeters, one for each pilot and one for backup but in this certain case all three were dead. This was followed by the loss of air speed indicator. With both the instruments failed the pilots were flying blind. Suddenly the altimeter comes back live. The pilot notices loss of altitude in the displayed altimeter and climbs immediately. The pilot then tries engaging the auto pilot. But, to engage the auto pilot the reading from both the pilots must be same but in this situation both the reading from both the pilots are different from each other. A **Mach speed trim** alert was raised, which indicate the plane is not fling in a leveled position. Then an over speed warning warning was raised. The pilot decides to land the pilot and an emergency was declared. The pilots relied on the ATC for the data on airspeed and altitude. But the data visible to the ATC controller had a problem, the airspeed is calculated with respect to the ground and was accurate but the altitude reading were displayed from the plane altitude meaning instrument which was wrong. Both the pilots and the ATC controller were unaware of this problem. For the pilots the plane seems to be steady but in fact they were descending slowly. All the warning that has been raised are contradicting in nature. Later a stall warning pops up along with overspeed warning which again is contradicting. The pilots asking if there can be any plane to guide the Boeing 757 considering the loss of crucial data to perform landing. At this point they were just 1,000 miles above sea level unaware. Now the pilot receive the ground proximity alarm. But, the ATC confirms that they were at 10,000 feet. But the ground proximity warning was actually correct, this is because the ground proximity is calculated using a different sensor and not from the altimeter. Later the pilots realized that they were flying too low, but they were too late to take any actions. The plane finally crashed into the ocean.

Investigation

The wreckage suggests that the plane crashed into the ocean at a high speed as one integrated speed. When search through the wreckage, the investigators learns that the static port that is used to measure the airspeed of the pilots side were completely blocked using a tape. It is usual that before cleaning the aircraft the static port would be taped to protect them but in this case the tape was not removed after the cleaning.

Changes that were brought after the incident

Boeing increased training on static covers and advised not to use un-authorized static covers.

Reference

1. Aero Peru 603 Boeing 757 Crash Pacific Ocean
`https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=K1kAH22Ma5M&list=WL&index=2`